

MNIC System User Manual

A brief guide for members and officers using the club management system

Use this manual for	What it helps you do
Members	Understand notifications, payments, obligations, meetings, proposals, and reports.
Officers	Record and review payments, manage members, run meetings, approve expenses, reconcile accounts, and keep audit-safe records.
Administrators	Maintain club settings, system roles, login accounts, external accounts, and audit records.

Important principle: the system separates the person who records something from the person who approves or verifies it. This protects the club by making important actions visible and reviewed.

1. Getting Around

The left sidebar is divided into Club work, Governance records, and Administration. You will only see some actions if your role allows them.

Area	Purpose
Dashboard	Quick summary of members, cash position, open period, pending payments, expenses, arrears, and reconciliation status.
Notifications	Alerts about things that need attention or confirm that something happened.
Members	Club roster and each member profile.
Contribution periods	Monthly contribution windows and member obligations.
Payments	Member contribution payments and verification.
Expenses	Club spending requests, approval, payment, and verification.
Reconciliation	Check app records against bank, mobile money, or cash statements.
Adjustments	Controlled corrections for periods that are already closed.

2. Roles and Access

Different users can do different things. The exact permissions are managed in System roles, but the usual responsibilities are:

- **Member:** views their records, notifications, meetings, proposals, and payments where allowed.
- **Secretary:** manages members, meetings, minutes, proposals, action items, and some audit records.
- **Treasurer:** manages contribution periods, payments, expenses, external accounts, reconciliations, and reports.
- **Financial verifier:** reviews payments, expenses, and financial records independently.
- **Administrator:** manages settings, roles, login accounts, and high-level system administration.

3. Members

The Members page is the club roster. It stores each member number, full name, phone, joined date, and current status.

Status	Meaning
Prospective	Added to the system but not yet fully admitted.
Active	Current participating member. Active members receive obligations when a contribution period opens.
Suspended	Temporarily inactive.
Exited / Removed	No longer active in the club.

Member profiles show status history, contribution obligations, payments, and audit activity where your role allows it.

4. Contribution Periods

A contribution period is the period the club is collecting contributions for. The current system is monthly. When a period is opened, the system creates one obligation for each active member.

Item	How it works
Amount	Copied from Club settings when the period is opened.
Due date	Built from the period month plus the due day in Club settings.
Grace date	Built from the period month plus the grace day in Club settings.
Obligations	Created for all active members at the time the period is opened.
History	Amount, due date, and grace date are copied into the period so later settings changes do not rewrite old records.

If the club wants weekly contributions, that is not just changing a setting. The system currently stores periods by year and month. Weekly contributions would need a new weekly period structure and weekly due/grace rules.

5. Payments

Payments are member contribution payments. A payment is not counted until it is verified.

Status	Meaning
Submitted	Payment has been recorded and is waiting for review.
Verified	A different officer checked it and the money now counts.
Rejected	The payment was not accepted; a reason is recorded.
Reversal pending	Someone asked to undo a verified payment; a second officer must decide.
Reversed	The reversal was approved and allocations were unwound.

Payment workflow:

- Record the payment with member, amount, paid date, method, reference, and optional evidence.
- The payment starts as submitted.
- A different officer verifies or rejects it. The recorder cannot review their own payment.
- When verified, the amount pays the member obligations oldest first, so arrears are settled before newer periods.
- Any extra amount becomes an unapplied advance.
- A verified payment can be reversed only through a request and second-officer approval.

6. Expenses

Expenses are money the club spends. The system uses a careful request, approval, payment, and verification flow.

Status	Meaning
Submitted	Expense request has been entered.
Approved	Another officer approved the request.
Rejected	The request was declined with a reason.
Paid	The club has paid it from an external account.
Verified	Another officer checked that the payment is valid.

- The requester cannot approve or reject their own expense.
- Only an approved expense can be marked as paid.
- The verifier cannot be the requester or the approver.
- Evidence can be uploaded when requesting the expense.

7. Reconciliation

Reconciliation checks whether the system balance agrees with an external statement, such as bank, mobile money, or cash records.

Step	What happens
Start	Choose contribution period and account, then enter opening balance and statement closing balance.
Submit	The system calculates expected closing balance: opening balance + verified payments - paid expenses.
Explain differences	Record reconciliation items for unexplained gaps, bank fees, missing entries, or corrections being followed up.
Confirm	A different officer confirms it after all items are resolved.
Lock	The reconciliation is locked and the contribution period is closed.

Once locked, the reconciliation should not be edited directly. This preserves the signed-off record.

8. Adjustments

Adjustments are controlled corrections for closed periods. They exist so the club does not secretly edit a month after it was reconciled and locked.

- Use a positive adjustment when a closed period was understated.
- Use a negative adjustment when a closed period was overstated.
- Every adjustment needs a reason.
- The person who requested the adjustment cannot approve or reject it.
- Open periods should be corrected at the original record instead of using adjustments.

9. Meetings and Minutes

Meetings keep the club calendar and records. Officers can schedule meetings, record attendance, create minutes, and update/correct minutes according to permissions.

- Use Meetings to see upcoming and past meetings.
- Use attendance to record who was present, absent, or sent apologies.
- Use minutes to preserve official meeting records.

10. Proposals and Voting

Proposals are formal decisions put before eligible members. A proposal can be drafted, opened for voting, closed, passed, rejected, or withdrawn.

- When voting opens, quorum and approval thresholds are copied from club settings so later settings changes do not affect that vote.
- Eligible members cast votes according to the rules configured for the proposal.
- Results are tracked with quorum and approval threshold information.

11. Positions and Elections

Positions represent club leadership roles. Elections, also called position polls, are used to nominate candidates, open voting, collect votes, and decide outcomes.

- Positions define the offices the club recognises.
- Election polls manage candidates and voting windows.
- Voting thresholds are copied when voting opens, so election history stays consistent.

12. Action Items

Action items track tasks from meetings or club operations. They can be assigned to members, given due dates, and updated as work progresses.

Status	Meaning
Open	The task exists but work has not meaningfully started.
In progress	Work is underway.
Blocked	Something is preventing progress.
Completed	The task is done.
Cancelled	The task is no longer needed.

13. Notifications

Notifications help users notice events that need attention. The sidebar badge shows unread notifications. Users can filter unread notifications and mark notifications as read.

- Payment verified or rejected.
- Contribution period opened or obligation due/overdue.
- Expense approved or rejected.
- Meeting or voting events where configured.
- Month closed after reconciliation is locked.

14. Reports and Exports

The system provides reports and exports for club records. Some reports are available as CSV or PDF depending on the page.

Report / Export	What it contains
Arrears	Members who still owe contributions after the grace period.
Payments	Verified payment records.
Expenses	Club expense records.
Governance	Meeting/proposal/election governance records.
Audit log	System activity history for permitted users.
Monthly reports	Contribution period summaries based on reconciled records.

15. Administration

Area	Use
Club settings	Set contribution amount, due day, grace day, quorum percent, and approval threshold. Update settings before opening new periods or votes.

Area	Use
External accounts	Maintain club bank, mobile money, or cash accounts used for payments, expenses, and reconciliation.
System roles	Control which roles can view, create, approve, verify, or administer records.
Login accounts	Create and manage user login access linked to members.
Audit log	Review who did what and when for important records.
Profile, password, appearance	Personal account and display preferences.

16. Good Practice Checklist

- Record clear references for every payment and expense.
- Upload evidence when available.
- Do not verify your own records; let another officer review them.
- Open contribution periods only after club settings are correct.
- Reconcile regularly, preferably every period.
- Use adjustments for closed periods instead of editing old signed-off records.
- Keep member statuses current so obligations are created for the right people.
- Review notifications often so urgent work does not sit unnoticed.

17. Common Questions

Question	Answer
Can the club pay weekly?	Not with the current monthly period design alone. Weekly collection would need new weekly period rules.
Do due and grace dates come from settings?	Yes. They are copied from club settings when a contribution period is opened.
Can a rejected payment count?	No. Only verified payments count.
Can a payment be undone?	Yes, but only by requesting a reversal and having another officer approve it.
Can a locked month be edited?	No. Use adjustments so the correction is visible and approved.